

The Address

By Marga Minco

MAIN POINTS:

- *Marga Minco is the author. The narrator was a girl of fifteen or seventeen. Her family was Jewish and Hitler was planning to kill all the Jews in Germany, Holland, Austria, etc..*
- *The war led to exodus of Jewish families towards safer places. They were forced to abandon their homes and belongings.*
- *This short story is a touching account of a daughter who goes in search of her mother's belongings after the War, in Holland.*
- *When she finds them, the objects evoke memories of her old life. However, she decides to leave them all behind and resolves to move on*
- *A lady named Mrs. Dorling comes to Mrs. S's house to give pre-war information to Mrs. S.*
- *The narrator happens to meet Mrs. Dorling on one of her visits to her house and remembers her taking away a suitcase full of their belongings.*
- *Mrs. S tells her daughter that Mrs. Dorling has good*

intentions of keeping their belongings safe during the war time. She has offered to help the narrator's family by carrying away their household utensils, furniture and all the other valuables.

- When the war was over and the Jews were feeling safe in these countries, the narrator returned to her house (which was no more!) and lived in a small hut. She has lost her mother and misses her dearly.

- One day the narrator thinks of the woman (Mrs. Dorling) who had taken all her possessions. She recalls her address - 46, Marconi Street and goes to the address by train.

- Mrs. Dorling opens the door and is surprised to see the narrator. When the narrator introduces herself she refuses to recognize her. Perhaps Mrs. Dorling was not expecting that she would ever return after the war.

- On the other hand, the narrator recognizes the woollen cardigan which Mrs. Dorling was wearing as it belonged to her mother.

- The narrator was terribly pinched, hurt, disappointed and betrayed by the behavior of Mrs. Dorling. Anyhow, the first visit ended on a sad note. She grew impatient after a while and decided to visit Mrs. Dorling once again.

- When she rang the bell at house number 46, Mrs. Dorling's daughter - meets the narrator and offers her a cup of tea.

Marga goes inside.

- She recognizes many articles that once belonged to her mother but were now being used in a distasteful manner by the Dorling family.
- The narrator is hurt and disgusted at the shrewdness of Mrs. Dorling. She loses the desire of taking back her mother's belongings as they evoke sad memories of the war and the painful loss of the mother in her heart.
- She resolves to forget the address and move on in life.

Q1. Why did the narrator go to Mrs. Dorling's house?

Ans. The narrator went to Mrs. Dorling's house to collect her valuable belongings which her mother had given it to her during war time. She wanted to renew her past memories.

Q2. Why was the narrator confident that she had reached the correct address?

Ans. The narrator remembered house No. 46, on Marconi street, which her mother had told her about it. She also recognized the green knitted cardigan with wooden buttons which Mrs. Dorling was wearing as it belonged to her mother.

Q3. How did Mrs. Dorling's daughter treat the narrator?

Ans. Unlike Mrs. Dorling, the daughter invited the narrator inside her house. She offered her cup of tea.

Q4. Why did the narrator decide not to collect her belongings?

Ans. The narrator was disappointed after recognising her belongings in a stale and dirty environment. She didn't feel comfortable on seeing all those valuable articles placed in a distasteful manner at Mrs. Dorling's house.

Q5. Why did the narrator's mother ask her to remember the address by heart?

Ans. The narrator's mother asked her to remember the address by heart because she gave a number of valuable household articles to Mrs. Dorling during the war time. She thought that her daughter would collect all that after the war was over.